

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner who closes the loop from epic to deployment.*

Positioning, nearly ten years translating complex operational workflows into scalable software systems, across regulated B2B environments and cross-functional Agile teams.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://www.true-north.berlin)

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Dear Hiring Team at First Advantage,

I am applying for the Product Owner role at First Advantage's Global Operating Centre. The position describes end-to-end lifecycle ownership for new strategic clients – vision, requirements, development, integration, deployment, adoption, and continuous improvement. That scope maps closely to the work I have done across my last three product roles, and I want to be specific about why.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I owned a central AI and data management platform for a multinational defence programme. The environment had strict data governance requirements, multinational stakeholders, and a cross-functional team of architects, data scientists, and frontend and backend engineers. I delivered features end-to-end – from user story to acceptance criteria to implementation support to GitOps rollout – and reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes by introducing ArgoCD. At Emil Group, I joined a B2B InsurTech platform mid-crisis: a bloated seventeen-person team, deteriorating sprint discipline, and a client relationship under real strain. I restructured the team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and ran weekly product workshops that rebuilt client trust enough to stabilise a contract that had been at risk. That combination of technical fluency and stakeholder discipline is precisely what a Product Owner coordinating a SWAT POD across QA, architecture, and development needs to do.

Your job description flags API integration documentation and communicating functionality to end users as explicit responsibilities. I have shipped both: at CLINET Platforms, I documented and managed a CGM API integration into hospital information system workflows and maintained transparent communication with clinical stakeholders about legacy API constraints and delivery timelines. At the Federal Employment Agency, I introduced Dagster for automated ETL pipeline management and served as Deputy IT Security Officer, which meant owning

compliance, governance, and data lineage – disciplines directly relevant to a background screening platform where data integrity is non-negotiable.

I do not have prior experience in the HR technology or background screening industry specifically, and I want to name that honestly. What I do have is a consistent track record of ramping into regulated, data-intensive B2B platforms quickly and delivering production value within weeks. The mechanics of translating business requirements into epics, managing refinement with cross-functional teams, and closing the loop from integration testing to stakeholder sign-off do not change significantly by industry vertical.

First Advantage's emphasis on global scale, automation, and customer success is exactly the environment where structured delivery discipline compounds. I would be glad to discuss how my background applies to the specific portfolio you are building out.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
